INTRODUCTION

THE HEART OF INNOVATION

When you hear the word "creativity," what do you think of next?

If you are like many people, your mind immediately leaps to artistic endeavors like sculpture, drawing, music, or dance.

You may equate "creative" with "artistic."

You may believe that architects and designers are paid to be creative thinkers, but CEOs, lawyers, and doctors are not.

Or you may feel that being creative is a fixed trait, like having brown eyes—either you're born with creative genes, or you're not.

As brothers who have worked together for thirty years at the forefront of innovation, we have come to see this set of misconceptions as "the creativity myth." It is a myth that far too many people share. This book is about the opposite of that myth. It is about what we call "creative confidence." And at its foundation is the belief that we are *all* creative.

The truth is, we all have far more creative potential waiting to be tapped.

We've helped thousands of companies bring breakthrough ideas to market—from Apple's first computer mouse to next-generation surgical tools for Medtronic to fresh brand strategies for The North Face in China. And we've also seen that our methods can produce a new creative mindset in people that can dramatically enhance their lives, whether they work in the fields of medicine, law, business, education, or science.

Over the past three decades, we've helped countless individuals nurture their creativity and put it to valuable use. They've created housing optimized for the needs of service men and women returning from war

zones. They've set up an ad hoc innovation team in a corporate hallway, generating so much energy and noise that the company gave them a dedicated project space. They've developed a low-cost system for screening and fitting hearing aids among elderly villagers in developing countries, providing benefit to some of the 360 million people in the world who suffer from disabling hearing loss. The people we've helped have many backgrounds but share one common trait: they all have gained creative confidence.

At its core, creative confidence is about believing in your ability to create change in the world around you. It is the conviction that you can achieve what you set out to do. We think this self-assurance, this belief in your creative capacity, lies at the heart of innovation.

> Belief in your creative capacity lies at the heart of innovation.

Creative confidence is like a muscle—it can be strengthened and nurtured through effort and experience. Our goal is to help build that confidence in you.

Whether you think of yourself as "the creative type" or not, we believe reading this book will help you unlock and draw on more of the creative potential that is within us all.

CREATIVITY NOW

Creativity is much broader and more universal than what people typically consider the "artistic" fields. We think of creativity as using your imagination to create something new in the world. Creativity comes into play wherever you have the opportunity to generate new ideas, solutions, or approaches. And we believe everyone should have access to that resource.

For much of the twentieth century the so-called "creative types"—designers, art directors, copy writers—were relegated to the kids' table, far from serious discussions. Meanwhile, all the important business conversations took place among the "grown-ups" in boardrooms and meeting spaces down the hall.

But the creative endeavors that seemed fanciful or extracurricular a decade ago have now gone mainstream. Education thought leader Sir Ken Robinson—whose riveting 2006 TED Talk asking "Do Schools Kill

Creativity?" was the most popular in history—says that creativity "is as important in education as literacy, and we should treat it with the same status."

In the business world, creativity manifests itself as innovation. Tech stars such as Google, Facebook, and Twitter have unleashed their employees' creativity to change the lives of billions of people. Today, in every department—from customer service to finance—people have opportunities to experiment with new solutions. Companies desperately need employees' insights from across the organization. No individual executive or division holds a monopoly on new ideas.

Whether you live in Silicon Valley or Shanghai, Munich or Mumbai, you've already felt the effects of seismic market shifts. Most businesses today realize that the key to growth, and even survival, is innovation. One recent IBM survey of more than 1,500 CEOs reports that creativity is the single most important leadership competency for enterprises facing the complexity of global commerce today. An Adobe Systems poll of five thousand people on three continents reports that 80 percent of people see unlocking creative potential as key to economic growth. Yet only 25 percent of these individuals feel that they're living up to their creative potential in their own lives and careers. That's a lot of wasted talent.

How might we shift that balance? How might we help the other 75 percent unleash their creative potential?

In 2005, David founded the d.school (formally known as the Hasso Plattner Institute of Design) to teach design thinking—a methodology for innovating routinely—to future entrepreneurs from Stanford's graduate schools. Originally, we thought that the primary challenge would be to teach creativity to people who saw themselves as "analytical types." We soon realized that all of the individuals we worked with *already* had creativity in spades.* Our job was simply to help them recapture it by sharing new skills and mindsets.

We have been stunned at how quickly people's imagination, curiosity, and courage are renewed with just a small amount of practice and encouragement.

For the people we've worked with, opening up the flow of creativity is like discovering that you've been driving a car with the emergency brake on—and suddenly experiencing what it feels like when you release the brake and can drive freely. We see this a lot with executives during workshops, or when we have clients in to collaborate side by side with us. They've sat through seminars about innovation before, and they are convinced they know how creative—or how *uncreative*—they're going to be. So when we get to

a point that's fuzzy or unconventional—like doing an improv exercise—suddenly they whip out their smartphones, heading for the exits to make "really important" phone calls.

Why? Because they are insecure about their abilities in that setting. They instinctively fall back on the defense that "I'm just not the creative type."

In our experience, *everybody* is the creative type. We know that if we can get individuals to stick with the methodology a while, they will end up doing amazing things. They come up with breakthrough ideas or suggestions and work creatively with a team to develop something truly innovative. They surprise themselves with the realization that they are a lot more creative than they had thought. That early success shakes up how they see themselves and makes them eager to do more.

What we've found is that we don't have to generate creativity from scratch. We just need to help people rediscover what they already have: the capacity to imagine—or build upon—new-to-the-world ideas. But the real value of creativity doesn't emerge until you are brave enough to act on those ideas. That combination of thought and action defines creative confidence: the ability to come up with new ideas and the courage to try them out.

Geshe Thupten Jinpa, who has been the Dalai Lama's chief English translator for more than twenty years, shared an insight with us recently about the nature of creativity. Jinpa pointed out that there's no word in the Tibetan language for "creativity" or "being creative." The closest translation is "natural." In other words, if you want to be more creative, you just have to be more natural. We forget that back in kindergarten, we were all creative. We all played and experimented and tried out weird things without fear or shame. We didn't know enough not to. The fear of social rejection is something we learned as we got older. And that's why it's possible to regain our creative abilities so swiftly and powerfully, even decades later.

It turns out that creativity isn't some rare gift to be enjoyed by the lucky few—it's a natural part of human thinking and behavior. In too many of us it gets blocked. But it can be unblocked. And unblocking that creative spark can have far-reaching implications for yourself, your organization, and your community.

We believe that our creative energy is one of our most precious resources. It can help us to find innovative solutions to some of our most intractable problems.

CREATIVE CONFIDENCE IN ACTION

Creative confidence is a way of experiencing the world that generates new approaches and solutions. We know that *anyone* can gain creative confidence. We have witnessed it in people from diverse backgrounds and careers. Everyone—from scientists in their labs to senior managers at Fortune 500 companies—can approach life differently, with a new outlook and a larger tool set. Here are a few examples of people who have embraced creative confidence:

Creative energy is one of our most precious resources.

- A former Olympian entered the airline industry and developed the confidence to tackle her company's crisis management problems head on. She gathered a volunteer task force of pilots, dispatchers, crew schedulers, and others to prototype procedures following weather-related flight disruptions, leading to a 40 percent faster recovery time.
- An army captain who served in Iraq and Afghanistan rallied over 1,700 people to petition for a pedestrian mall in the local community, proving you don't have to be a general to have an impact.
- Going beyond just the raw facts of a case, a law school student took a human-centered approach to her mock trial. She had the jury picture themselves at the scene of the incident to imagine what it felt like. And through harnessing their empathy, she won—the first time a jury had ever favored her side of that particular case.
- A former government executive started a grassroots innovation movement in Washington, D.C., that has grown to over a thousand members. Through workshops and networking events, she is spreading her new perspective on organizational change to other leaders and aspiring entrepreneurs.
- After four decades of experience, an elementary school teacher restructured her curriculum into design challenges. Instead of teaching discrete subjects, she created projects that covered the same topics but got students to step away from their desks and think more critically. Their test scores improved, but more important, parents noticed their children were more engaged and inquisitive.

You don't have to switch careers or move to Silicon Valley to change your mindset. You don't have to become a design consultant or quit your

job. The world needs more creative policy makers, office managers, and real estate agents. Whatever your profession, when you approach it with creativity, you'll come up with new and better solutions and more successes. Creative confidence can inspire whatever work you already do —because you gain a new tool to enhance your problem-solving practices without having to abandon any of your existing techniques.

You don't have to switch careers or move to Silicon Valley to change your mindset.

We've talked to doctors who have found new ways to empathize with and more effectively treat their patients, looking beyond the surface symptoms. We've talked to executive recruiters who use our methods to find new matchups between talented people and the companies that need them most. We've talked to social workers who use human-centered approaches to help people in the community understand confusing application forms.

People with creative confidence have a greater impact on the world around them—whether that means getting involved with their child's school, turning a storage room into a vibrant innovation space, or harnessing social media to recruit more bone marrow donors.

As legendary psychologist and Stanford professor Albert Bandura has shown, our belief systems affect our actions, goals, and perception. Individuals who come to believe that they can effect change are more likely to accomplish what they set out to do. Bandura calls that conviction "self-efficacy." People with self-efficacy set their sights higher, try harder, persevere longer, and show more resilience in the face of failure.

Our practical experience in the world of innovation and creative confidence aligns closely with his findings. When people transcend the fears that block their creativity, all sorts of new possibilities emerge. Instead of being paralyzed by the prospect of failure, they see every experience as an opportunity they can learn from. The need for control keeps some people stuck at the planning stage of a project. With creative confidence, they become comfortable with uncertainty and are able to leap into action. Instead of resigning themselves to the status quo, or what others have told them to do, they are freed to speak their mind and challenge existing ways of doing things. They act with greater courage, and have more persistence in tackling obstacles.

We believe this book will help you overcome the mental blocks that hold back your creativity. Chapter by chapter, we will give you tools that

empower you to pursue new ideas with confidence. The stories, methods, and practices that we will share draw on decades of collaboration with creative thinkers everywhere, and we believe they will help you too.

THE CREATIVE CONFIDENCE QUEST

Today, our mission as authors is to help as many people as possible rediscover their creative potential.

Confronted with their newfound creativity, people sometimes confide in us that their mother was a dancer, or their father was an architect. They seem to be rationalizing their spark of creative energy, as if they are searching for concrete evidence. What they don't realize is that their creative potential was always a part of them—not because of any family history or genetic predisposition, but because it is a natural human ability within us all.

Creative confidence is a way of seeing that potential and your place in the world more clearly, unclouded by anxiety and doubt.

We hope you'll join us on our quest to embrace creative confidence in our lives. Together, we can all make the world a better place.

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[*] A note about "we": This book has two authors, so you will see the first person plural a *lot*. When talking about just one of us, we will say "David" or "Tom." In some contexts, however, the "we" will mean the team at IDEO, where the two of us work, or the faculty and staff of the d.school, where David spends time.

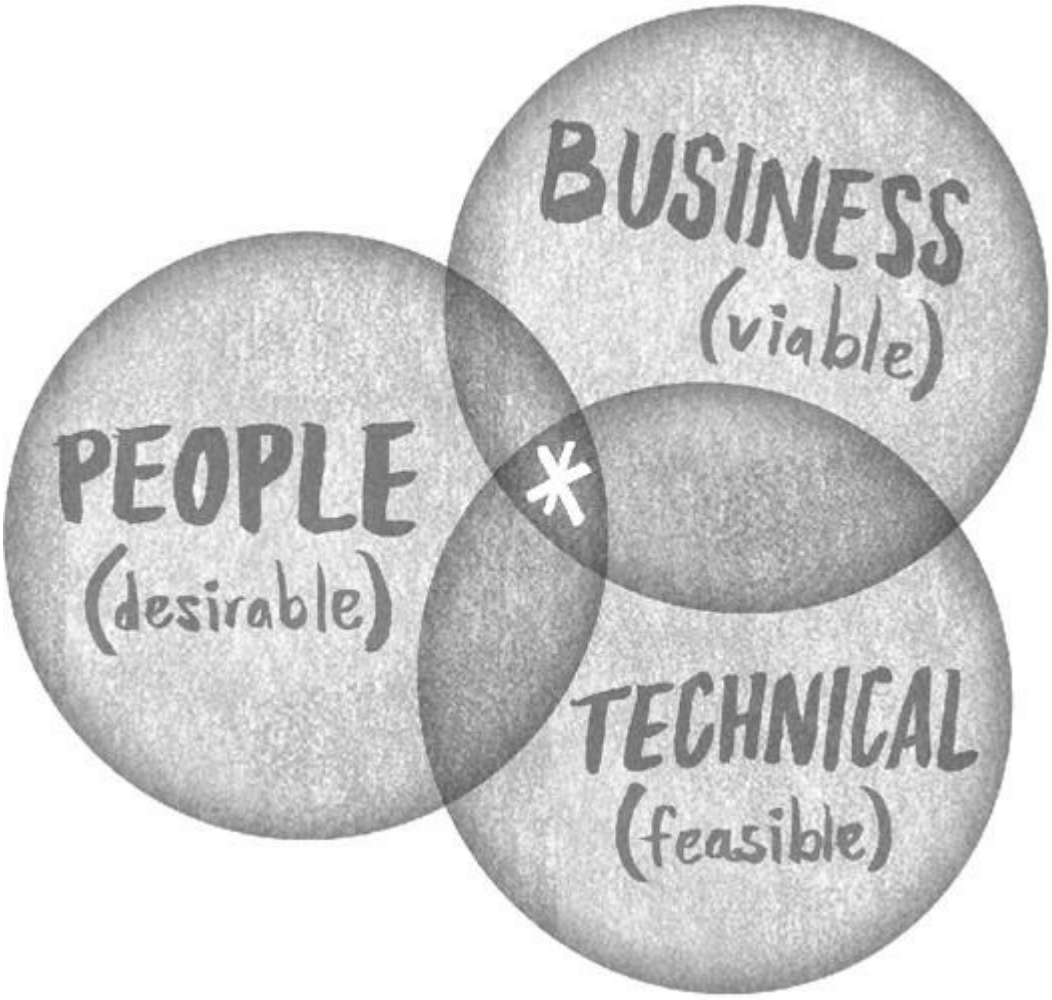
CHAPTER 1 EXCERPTS

FLIP

A creative mindset can be a powerful force for looking beyond the status quo. People who use the creative techniques we outline are better able to apply their imagination to painting a picture of the future. They believe they have the ability to improve on existing ideas and positively impact the world around them, whether at work or in their personal lives.

New opportunities for innovation open up when you start the creative problem-solving process with empathy toward your target audience—whether it's kids or colleagues, clients or consumers. In our experience, approaching challenges from a human perspective can yield some of the richest opportunities for change.

In every innovation program we have been involved with, there are always three factors to balance, represented by the three overlapping circles in the diagram below:



The first has to do with *technical factors*, or feasibility. In the early days of our work in Silicon Valley, this is where our clients always started. We've had clients present us with literally thousands of new technologies, from clever new wheel hubs for bicycles to new ways of chilling the human brain from the inside. A new technology—if it truly works—can be extremely valuable, and can provide the basis for a successful new company or a new line of business. Carbon fiber aircraft components, multi-touch interactive displays, and minimally invasive surgical tools all revolutionized their industries. But cool technology alone is not enough. If it were, we'd all be riding Segways and playing with robotic dogs.

The second key element is economic viability, or what we sometimes refer to as *business factors*. Not only does the technology need to work, but it also needs to be produced and distributed in an economically viable way. It needs to fit into a business model that will allow the enterprise to thrive.

When we were growing up in the 1950s, Popular Science magazine suggested that twenty-first-century families would have their own personal helicopter in the backyard. So far, no one has come up with a clever business model to make helicopters affordable for ordinary people. The business factors on that concept just never lined up—and maybe never will. Even in nonprofit organizations, business factors can be critical. If you want to launch a program to increase the availability of safe drinking water in India or to build sanitation systems in Ghana, you need to find a way for it to pay for and sustain itself in the long run.

Cool technology alone is not enough. If it were, we'd all be riding Segways and playing with robotic dogs.

The third element involves people, and is sometimes referred to as *human factors*. It's about deeply understanding human needs. Beyond just observing behaviors, this third aspect of successful innovation programs is about getting at people's motivations and core beliefs. Human factors aren't necessarily more important than the other two. But technical factors are well taught in science and engineering programs around the world, and companies everywhere focus energy on the business factors. So we believe that human factors may offer some of the best opportunities for innovation, which is why we always start there. And Doug did too, because GE's MRI machines already had great technology and business viability. Doug worked to understand how young children perceive MRI machines and what makes them feel safe when introduced to a new experience. Doug's empathy for his young patients led him to a breakthrough idea and ultimately assured his product's success.

Being human centered is at the core of our innovation process. Deep empathy for people makes our observations powerful sources of inspiration. We aim to understand why people do what they currently do, with the goal of understanding what they might do in the future. Our first-person experiences help us form personal connections with the people for whom we're innovating. We've washed other people's clothes by hand in their sinks, stayed as guests in housing projects, stood beside surgeons in operating rooms, and calmed agitated passengers in airport security lines—all to build empathy. An empathic approach fuels our process by ensuring we never forget we're designing for real people. And as a result, we uncover insights and opportunities for truly creative solutions. We've collaborated with thousands of clients to leverage the power of empathy, creating everything from easy-to-use lifesaving heart defibrillators to debit cards that help customers save for retirement.

We believe successful innovations rely on some element of human-centered design research while balancing the two other elements. Seeking that sweet spot of feasibility, viability, and desirability as you take into account the real needs and desires of your customers is part of what we at IDEO and the d.school call "design thinking." It's our process for creativity and innovation. There's no one-size-fits-all methodology for bringing new ideas to life, but many successful programs include a variation on four steps: inspiration, synthesis, ideation/experimentation, and implementation. In our experience, an innovation or new idea may cycle through many iterations before the process is complete.

DESIGN-DRIVEN INNOVATION

Here's an overview of our approach to innovation, as described by IDEO partner Chris Flink. We adapt and evolve our methodologies continuously, so please feel free to make your own variations, as well, fashioning innovation techniques that fit your unique circumstances.

1. INSPIRATION

Don't wait for the proverbial apple to fall on your head. Go out in the world and proactively seek experiences that will spark creative thinking. Interact with experts, immerse yourself in unfamiliar environments, and role-play customer scenarios. Inspiration is fueled by a deliberate, planned course of action.

To inspire human-centered innovation, empathy is our reliable, go-to resource. We find that connecting with the needs, desires, and motivations of real people helps to inspire and provoke fresh ideas. Observing people's behavior in their natural context can help us better understand the factors at play and trigger new insights to fuel our innovation efforts. We shadow and do interviews with a variety of people out in the field. We speak to "extreme users," for example, discovering how early adopters make clever use of technology. Or, if we are redesigning a kitchen tool like a can opener, we may observe how elderly people use it to look for points of frustration or opportunities for improvement. We look to other industries to see how relevant challenges are addressed. For instance, we may draw parallels between customer service at a restaurant and the patient experience at a hospital in order to improve patient satisfaction.

2. SYNTHESIS

After your time in the field, the next step is to begin the complex challenge of "sense-making." You need to recognize patterns, identify themes, and find meaning in all that you've seen, gathered, and observed. We move from concrete observations and individual stories to more abstract truths that span across groups of people. We often organize our observations on an "empathy map" or create a matrix to categorize types of solutions.

During synthesis, we strive to see where the fertile ground is. We translate what we've uncovered in our research into actionable frameworks and principles. We reframe the problem and choose where to focus our energy. For example, in retail environments, we've discovered that if you change the question from "how might we reduce customer waiting time?" to "how might we reduce *perceived* waiting time?" it opens up whole new avenues of possibility, like using a video display wall to provide an entertaining distraction.

3. IDEATION AND EXPERIMENTATION

Next, we set off on an exploration of new possibilities. We generate countless ideas and consider many divergent options. The most promising ones are advanced in iterative rounds of rapid prototypes—early, rough representations of ideas that are concrete enough for people to react to. The key is to be quick and dirty—exploring a range of ideas without becoming too invested in only one. These experiential learning loops help to develop existing concepts and spur new ones. Based on feedback from end users and other stakeholders, we adapt, iterate, and pivot our way to human-centered, compelling, workable solutions. Experimentation can include everything from crafting hundreds of physical models for delivering transdermal vaccines to using driving simulators for testing new vehicle systems to acting out the check-in experience at a hotel lobby.

4. IMPLEMENTATION

Before a new idea is rolled out, we refine the design and prepare a road map to the marketplace. Of course, rollouts can vary wildly

depending on which elements of an experience or product are involved. Going live with a new online learning platform is very different from offering a new banking service. The implementation phase can have many rounds. More and more companies in every industry are beginning to launch new products, services, or businesses in order to learn. They live in beta, and quickly iterate through new in-market loops that further refine their offering. For example, some retailers launch pop-up stores as a way to test demand in new cities. And Boston-based startup Clover Food Lab began with a single food truck at MIT to gauge the market for its sustainable vegetarian food before the company committed to opening brick-and-mortar restaurant locations.

BORN TO FLIP—THE BIRTH OF THE D.SCHOOL

In the early 2000s, David started experimenting with team teaching at Stanford with professors from other parts of the university (like Terry Winograd from Computer Science, Bob Sutton from Management Science and Engineering, and Jim Patell from the business school. Prior to that, David had taught only students in the design division at the School of Engineering who already identified themselves as creative. In these new interdisciplinary courses, however, he worked with MBAs and computer science students who often didn't think of themselves that way.

It was in these classrooms that David and his colleagues could see what unlocking creativity really looked like.

Some of the students went beyond just using the tools and embraced the philosophy of design thinking, and in doing so, they developed a new mental outlook, a new self-image, and a new sense of empowerment. Students began visiting him during office hours—sometimes months after the class was over—to tell him that they had started to see themselves as creative individuals for the first time. That they could apply creativity to *any* challenge. Their eyes would light up with excitement, with a sense of opportunity, of possibility. Sometimes they cried.

David came up with a name for the transformation he was observing: "flipping"—**changing from one state of mind to another.** The playfulness of the term "flipping" reminded him of the joyful poetry of a somersault on a trampoline or a diving board.

These students he talked with were engaged and excited in a way that made it clear something in them had changed—permanently. It was the sort of profound impact educators live for.

Along with former student George Kembel (now executive director of the d.school), David began to talk with friends and colleagues about starting a new program. He envisioned a place in the university where students from different backgrounds could come to nurture their creative talents and apply their newfound skills to tough challenges. David pointed out that Stanford—like all world-class universities—had Nobel-laureate-quality researchers drilling deeper into their own fields of knowledge. But he suggested that there are tremendous challenges in the twenty-first century that aren't going to be solved that way. Maybe some solutions will be found by putting that scientist into a room with a businessperson, and a lawyer, and an engineer, and others. Rather than keeping all their eggs in the "going deep" basket, David proposed that Stanford make at least a small side bet on "going broad." And one day the new institute might have the respect and the cachet of the graduate school of business—commonly known as the "B-school." That's how the new venture got its nickname, which has stuck ever since: the "d.school."

When he told Hasso Plattner, one of the founders of enterprise software giant SAP, about the idea, Hasso generously reached for his checkbook. The d.school—officially known as the Hasso Plattner Institute of Design—opened its doors in 2005.

One prerequisite for achieving creative confidence the belief that your innovation skills and capabilit are not set in stone.

A GROWTH STATE OF MIND

One prerequisite for achieving creative confidence is the belief that your innovation skills and capabilities are not set in stone. If you currently feel that you are not a creative person—if you think, "I'm not good at that kind of thing"—you have to let go of that belief before you can move on. You have to *believe* that learning and growth are possible. In other words, you need to start with what Stanford psychology professor Carol Dweck calls a "growth mindset."

Individuals with a growth mindset, Dweck says, "believe that a person's true potential is unknown (and unknowable; that it's impossible to foresee what can be accomplished with years of passion, toil, and training." She makes a compelling case, backed up by extensive research, that regardless of our initial talent, aptitude, or even IQ, we can expand our capabilities through effort and experience.

To fully appreciate the growth mindset, it helps to contrast it with its all-too-familiar evil twin, the fixed mindset. Consciously or unconsciously, people with a fixed mindset have the deep-seated belief that everyone is born with only a certain amount of intelligence and a certain amount of talent. If invited on a journey to creative confidence, people with a fixed mindset will prefer to stay behind in their comfort zone, afraid that the limits of their capabilities will be revealed to others.

Dweck explored the self-limiting nature of a fixed mindset in studying the behavior of freshman students at the University of Hong Kong. Since all classes and exams at the university are in English, incoming students who struggle with the English language are at a distinct disadvantage. After assessing the students' language skills and their mindset, Dweck asked the incoming students a question: "If the faculty offered a course for students who need to improve their English skills, would you take it?" Their answers revealed the power of mindset. "Students with the growth mindset said an emphatic yes. But those with the fixed mindset were not very interested." In other words, those under the influence of a fixed mindset were willing to sabotage their long-term chances for success rather than expose a potential weakness. If they let the same logic guide their choices throughout life, it's easy to understand how their perception of their own abilities as permanently limited can become a self-fulfilling hypothesis.

A growth mindset, on the other hand, is a passport to new adventures.

When you open your mind to the possibility that your capabilities are unlimited and unknown, you already have your running shoes on and are ready to race forward.

In reality, we all have a little of both mindsets. Sometimes the fixed mindset whispers in one ear: "We've never been good at anything creative, so why embarrass ourselves now?" And the growth mindset whispers in the other ear: "Effort is the path to mastery, so let's at least give this a try." The question is, which voice are you going to listen to?

MAKE YOUR DENT IN THE UNIVERSE

With creative confidence comes the desire to proactively guide the course of your life, or your organization, rather than be carried along on the prevailing winds. Roger Martin, dean of the University of Toronto's Rotman School of Management, once told us that what stuck out to him about designers is that they always act with intention. While others may unconsciously go with the default option, design thinkers make everything a conscious and original choice: from how they arrange their bookshelf to how they present their work. When they look around the world, they see opportunities to do things better and have a desire to change them. Once you start creating things, whether it's laying out a new garden or starting a new company or writing a new piece of code, you start to realize that everything has that intention behind it. Everything in modern society is the result of a collection of decisions made by someone. Why shouldn't that someone be you?

When you unleash your creative confidence, you start to see new ways to improve on the status quo—from how you throw a dinner party to how you run a meeting. And once you become aware of those opportunities, you have to start seizing them.

To us, that focused "intentionality" was one of Steve Jobs's defining characteristics. David met Steve back in 1980 when we designed the first Apple mouse. They became friends during a dozen subsequent projects for Steve's ventures at Apple, NeXT, and Pixar. Steve never took the path of least resistance. He never accepted the world "as is." He did everything with intentionality. No detail was too small to escape his attention. He also pushed us beyond what we thought we could do—we experienced his "reality distortion field" firsthand. He just kept raising the bar, even when it seemed unreasonable. But we would try, and we would get three-quarters of the way there, which was always farther than we would have gotten by ourselves.

> Once you start creating things, you realize that everything has intention behind it.

After Steve was forced out of Apple and was planning the startup that would become NeXT Computer, he stopped by David's office one day to talk about his vision for the new machine. Always seeking Zen simplicity, Steve asked David, "What's the simplest three-dimensional shape in the world?" David was sure that it was a sphere. But that didn't matter, because the answer Steve was looking for was a cube. And so began our project of helping Steve with the engineering design of his cube-shaped NeXT computer.

During that intense project, Steve often called David at home in the middle of the night (in the era before e-mail and texting) to insist that we make some change. What kind of pressing issue couldn't wait until morning? One night, the call was about whether the plating on some screw on the inside of the cast magnesium cube should be cadmium or nickel. David's response was something like "Jeez, Steve, it's on the *inside* of the box." But Steve still cared—and we of course changed it. We don't know if any NeXT customer ever cracked open the machine and saw those perfectly plated fasteners, but Steve left no such details to chance.

Steve had a deep sense of creative confidence. He believed—he *knew*—that you can achieve audacious goals if you have the courage and perseverance to pursue them. He was famous for his exhortation to "make a

dent in the universe," which he expressed this way in a 1994 interview:

> The minute that you understand that you can poke life and actually something will … pop out the other side, that you can change it, you can mold it, that's maybe the most important thing … Once you learn that, you'll never be the same again.

Steve's message was that we all have the ability to change the world. That was certainly true of Steve, a visionary who impacted so many people's lives and urged us all to "Think Different."

From Doug Dietz to Steve Jobs, all of the creatively confident people we've crossed paths with have found a way to apply extraordinary energy and exert remarkable influence. And we know that as you gain creative confidence going forward, you will have the chance to make your own dent in the universe. Start with a growth mindset, the deep-seated belief that your true potential is still unknown. That you are not limited to only what you have been able to do before. In subsequent chapters we'll offer practical tools that will help you to acquire new skills, find new inspiration, and unleash more of your creative capacities. To do so, you will need to act, and to experience your own creativity firsthand. But to act, most of us must first overcome the fears that have blocked our creativity in the past.